The Poison Bottle

Examination photographs and the preview record

Before the Death

The real glass bottle stood on an open stand at the 6:20–6:28 PM preview. There was no glass cover. It had arrived closed.

Front of Bottle



Back of Seal

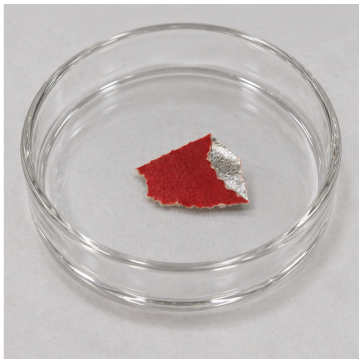


New red paper with a silver backing crossed the stopper. A split at the back was hidden from the front.

Unused Sealing Paper



Scrap from Grant's Glass



The scrap resembles the unused sealing paper: red on one side, silver on the other. Their torn edges do not make a unique match.

ACT III: METHOD

The Toast and the Camera

Service records, photographs and the technician's report

Grant's Individual Drink

The paid toast order included flavoring for Grant's glass. The shared punch was unflavored.

Sample	Cyanide	Flavoring
Shared punch	Not found	Not found
Flavoring container	Not found	Found
Grant's glass	Found	Found

Before the Toast



Grant Drinking



The shop delivered Grant's crest-engraved glass before setup. It stood unwrapped and uncovered. He drank from it; the water bottle stayed sealed.

The Room Camera

The request was to remove the room from the public monitor. The approved work disconnected its power. The network cable stayed attached; the unpowered camera recorded nothing.

A technology demonstrator supplied sample images and proposed connecting to this existing camera.

ACT III: METHOD

Grant's Estate File

PRIVATE VIDEO / TRANSCRIPT EXCERPT / FOR MY EXECUTORS

If I die before this gift is settled, read the unsigned papers. Artie will lose my donation rather than accept it without a board vote.

The family gets a board seat only if the gift is accepted. They already want the appointment while I am alive.

Sue has stopped my public announcement. My private toast can go ahead.

The bowl is off the market. The historic bottle stays on loan. Vincent will not let me print his painting. I can withhold his last payment.

Dada, I rejected your live stunt. I asked for a film. I have rejected that too.

ANNOUNCEMENT DESK / RETAINED ORIGINAL

Master: UNSIGNED / WITHDRAWN. Public copy held by coordinator. Separate private copy held by Grant.

ACCOUNTS / RETURNED ITEMS

Gala settlement attachments

Elon: camera connection	Invoice REJECTED: connection not installed.
Staff wages	Paid from restricted funds without approval.
Gala fabric	Paid from another client’s commission advance.
Sculpture	Resin + metal powder. Label corrected; final payment reduced.
Sculpture sample	Materials: bronze powder + gold leaf. Sealing paper: NONE.
Family appraisal	Condition: INTACT. Comparison used: DAMAGED object.
Sale endorsement	Withdrawal received BEFORE public announcement.
School places	Workshop funds used. Paid weekend session CANCELED.

ACT III: METHOD

The Registrar's Working File

BOTTLE / RECEIVING COPY

The purchase requires original contents, not an empty bottle or replica. Seller confirms contents retained; no cancellation or substitution received. Received before gala: closed bottle, dealer’s note, complete seller terms. Loan caption: “Contents inert.”

OCTOBER 29, 2026 / STAFF PROOF / DR. ART E. FACT TO INTAKE

Seller requires original contents. Lender calls contents inert. Please clarify before opening.

Intake reply: Unresolved. Keep closed.

OUTGOING COPIES / Staff: full query, seller attachment, restriction. Press: Reed DeLabel’s marked caption.

Press proof: Contents inert. ~~Purchase condition requires original contents to remain.~~

CLOSURE TREATMENT / RETAINED COPIES

Red paper fitted across stopper

SIGNED ORIGINAL	CHIP’S INSURANCE COPY
October 30, 2026	**October 29, 2026**

COLLECTION OFFICE / FILE CHECKS

Cupboard lock, after preview	Staff keys: OPEN. Founder’s spare: OPEN.
Bowl label correction	“Ownership settled” WITHDRAWN. Supporting papers missing.
Ownership file	Claimants’ letter + earlier acquisition advice. No ministry return order enclosed.
Lender descriptions	Old rule: publish before supporting papers arrive. Revised rule: review papers first.
Press correction	Correction concerns the former owner’s name only. No claim of poison treatment.

The Press Desk Originals

PAIGE TURNER / UNTRIMMED RECORDER

SERVICE MANAGER: Mr. Larceny, I'll leave your glass here. I'm going back to the kitchen about that added course.

GRANT: Thank you. Paige, I asked for a quiet private place. Why have you followed me here?

PAIGE: You agreed to an interview about the gift. It's on the recorder.

GRANT: It's the gala. I'm announcing the gift tonight. Ask about that, or we'll speak tomorrow.

ROBIN: Grant, here is your copy. The museum already has one. Return the bowl intact or give the claimants a hearing.

GRANT: This is my private room, Robin, not the public podium. I'm already answering the reporter. I am not reading a petition here.

PRODUCTION COPY / RECEIVED BEFORE GALA



Original sound: “Jacket take” → chair scrape → clatter. Picture and sound received together. Podcast master: same sequence. Teaser starts after “Jacket take.”

PICTURE EDITOR / CARD RECEIPT

Copied complete card after preview, before returning it. Import: physical bottle on open stand; no toast photograph. Photographer’s agency export supplied later.

Agency correction: earlier gallery photo was commercial, supplied as news. Public podium visible; disputed purchase cropped out.

INSTALLATION / COMPLETED CHANGES

Grant’s place setting	Proposed transparent cover CANCELED on BOTH styling copies.
Bottle stand	Proposed glass front NOT INSTALLED.
Textile projection	Magnified stitches only.
Alcove	Hanging load REMOVED; route CLOSED.

Docent: “We returned to the public cases. We never entered Grant’s room or stopped at his place.”

ACT III: METHOD

Two Photo Comparisons

Artist's reference and delivery records

The Artist's Reference

Painted Wooden Model



Historic Glass Bottle



The artist supplied a painting. The wooden model has visible joints; the preview bottle is glass. No model swap was authorized.

The Damaged Frame

Before Delivery: Intact



On Arrival: New Crack



The first report called the crack old damage. The handler's signed correction records damage during delivery.